

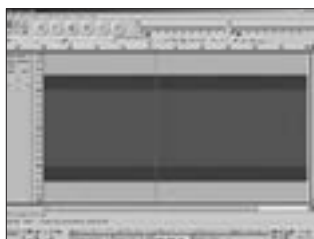
waveform and try and get two repetitions of a beat to fit into your display. To simplify, listen to the drums of the track. Listen for the beat sequence or the rhythm of the track. Once you have established a pattern, try and zoom in to easily fit two repetitions of that same beat sequence. This is how you can identify areas in the waveform to edit (cut / copy / paste).

Let's look at the intro to a song:

In this track, the intro is a simple drum beat, which repeats twice before the other instruments kick in. Though we loved the song, we wished the catchy drum beat would continue a little longer before the other instruments joined in. Though the artists didn't mean to make the song that way, we decided we'd just make it the way we wanted it, with help from Audacity.

First, as you can see in the screenshot, we zoomed in to the right level to get the rhythm right. We then proceeded to mark the area in the waveform that we wanted to repeat.

Here's where you have to make sure that you cut or copy a waveform selection from a point where the amplitude is 0—that is, a point where the wave meets the X axis. The reason for this is that at this point, for a very, very short time, there is no sound being emitted. Thus,



The waveform of a constant pitch



A waveform of a typical rock ballad



Copying part of a waveform from a song